YIFEI SUN

Principal Software Engineer · Backend Platform Infrastructure & Distributed Systems · 13 Years

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Airbnb Hiring Team
Staff Backend Engineer, Platform Infrastructure

Dear Airbnb Hiring Team,

I've been an Airbnb guest many times and appreciate how seamless the experience feels — which means the backend platform behind it is doing its job well. Building and evolving that kind of infrastructure at Airbnb's scale is exactly the challenge I'm looking for.

I'm a Principal Engineer with 13 years building backend platform infrastructure that other teams depend on. My most impactful project was redesigning the API orchestration layer behind my company's highest-traffic page, reducing p99 latency 5× and improving availability to 99.9% across 10+ teams and 3 departments. I've built GraphQL federation gateways with Netflix DGS, event-driven microservice platforms, and architectural standards adopted org-wide. The through-line is building reliable foundations that make other teams faster.

What excites me about Airbnb's backend platform roles is the combination of massive scale, service-oriented architecture, and direct impact on the guest and host experience. Evolving a large-scale production system while maintaining reliability is harder than building from scratch, and it's where I do my best work.

Sincerely,

Yifei Sun